1956; the Six-Day War in 1967; the War of Attrition from 1970 to 1971; and the Yom Kippur War in 1973. During these twenty-five years, the first generation of Israeli independence, the building blocks of its military doctrine were formed.

The first building block is deterrence, the practical meaning of which is the creation of a balance of terror in which the enemy knows—or thinks—that a provocation will cost him a price that is too heavy to bear, namely prohibitive retaliation. The principle of deterrence as one of the building blocks of a national security doctrine applies to any country that has enemies, let alone a small country like Israel, which was surrounded by enemy states in those years.

The second building block is early warning, which has double layers: strategic warning, which requires intelligence infiltration at the decision-making level in order to uncover the enemy's intentions, and tactical and operative warning, which relates to the timing of the outbreak of war and the enemy's war plans.

The third block is "subjugate/vanquish," which means comprehensive military capability that guarantees absolute superiority over the enemy.

The rationale behind these three building blocks is that *even if deterrence fails, and even if there is no warning, we still have the ability to defeat the enemy.* This was the case in the Yom Kippur War, with one difference—we did have a warning, but it was interpreted incorrectly by those in charge of assessing national intelligence—and a warning that is not interpreted correctly is the same as no warning at all.

The fourth building block is the principle of moving the war into enemy territory as quickly as possible. The rationale underlying this principle is the absence of *strategic depth,* and the understanding that Israel as a general rule does not embark on preventive wars. Additional considerations are to try to turn the enemy from an attacker into a defender in minimal time and to minimize damage to the home territory and its citizens. The necessary conditions for the realization of these objectives are qualitative intelligence on the enemy's capabilities and operational intelligence on targets in the enemy territory.

From all of the above, we can see that Israel's lack of strategic depth required it to adopt and develop an offensive defense doctrine, with the exception of the option of preventive war. The absence of preventive war from Israel's strategic arsenal is anchored in the political explanation that if